

AIMO Proof Pilot — Final Grade

Problem (#_ID): 3_INDEX

Submission: model_6

Scoring scale (0/1/6/7) — two binary decisions:

Step 1. Is the solution essentially complete?

- If **no**: award **1** for significant partial progress, otherwise **0**.
- If **yes**: award **7**, or **6** if there is a minor error or omission.

Grade against the **markscheme** (docs/markschemes.pdf).

1. Final mark

Final mark (choose one):

2. Reasoning

Justify the mark with explicit reference to the markscheme points (e.g. **ME1**) where possible.

An essentially complete solution matching the official approach. It sets up the polynomials, proves the key lemma, correctly rules out $\text{index} \geq 6$, attains index 5 (so $N = 5$), and establishes $M = 16$ with a valid example. The one genuine defect is in the final bounding step: passing from $q_1 > 0$ to $q_1 \geq 1$ needs q_1 to be an integer — i.e. that f/L_5 has integer coefficients — which is used but never justified (**ME2**). Essentially complete with a minor error, so scores **6**.